THE MANY CLANS OF
THE ALLIANCE
OF FREE PLANETS



AN ILLUSTRATED GUIDE TO
THE PEOPLE AND CULTURES
OF THE ALLIANCE

THIRD EDITION

UPDATED 96 AA

CLASS 0 - UNREGISTERED / INELIGIBLE

Class 0 clans are refused entry to Alliance space, and may not apply for citizenship. These are races that are undocumented or have features believed to be dangerous to the Alliance's free citizens.

CLASS 1 - DISCORDANT

Class 1 clans, or "discordant" clans, are those with ties to enemies of the Alliance of Free Planets, or who have proven themselves unworthy of the Alliance's trust. Members of Class 1 clans can apply for citizenship, but are subject to a number of restrictions within Alliance space, as follows.

- Class 1 citizens are not allowed to hold positions of political power.
- Class 1 citizens cannot enlist in the Alliance Navy.
- Class 1 citizens may be denied entry to core Alliance worlds or stations.

These restrictions may be lifted for specific individuals if said individual has proved their loyalty to the Alliance, though these cases are rare.

CLASS 2 - FREE

Class 2 clans, or free clans, make up a large portion of the Alliance's population. These clans are those who have no direct political ties to the Alliance, but whose presences poses no threat to its citizens.

Members of Class 2 clans may apply for citizenship and have no restrictions on the actions they may take in Alliance space, assuming they follow Alliance law.

Class 2 clans may be promoted to class 3 clans under the right circumstances, or demoted to Class 1 if they pose a threat to freedom.

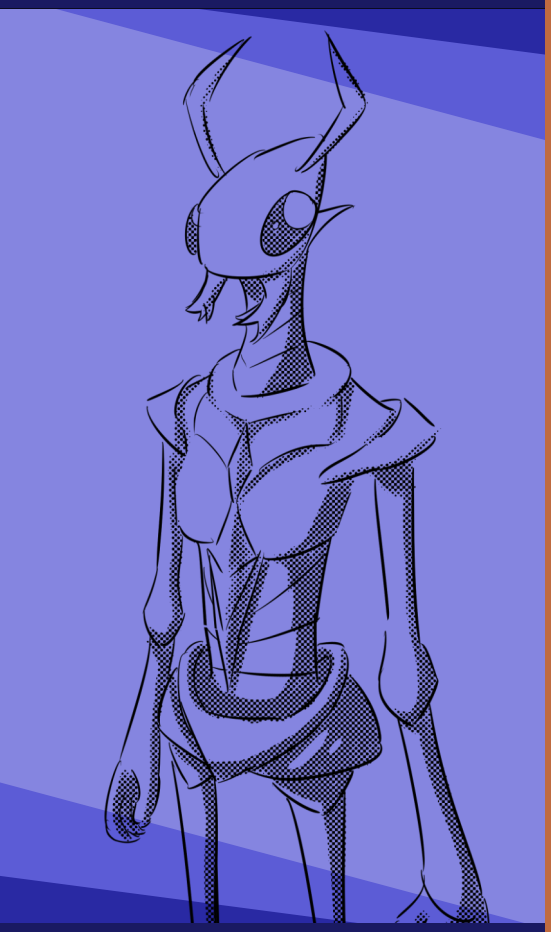
CLASS 3 - RENOWNED

Class 3 clans, also known as "Renowned" clans or member clans, are those who have direct political ties to the Alliance. For example, the ruling power of planet Zaa directly reports to the Alliance and follows their laws and customs, so the clans of Zaa are considered Class 3 clans.

Members of Class 3 clans are automatically considered citizens of the Alliance, though they may still need to register their identity to gain the benefits of citizenship. Class 3 citizens are not above the law, and have no inherent rights that set them apart from Class 2 citizens.

As these clans are integral to the Alliance, it is almost unthinkable for one to be demoted to a lower class.

NAFERI



CLASS 2 - FREE

The Naferi originate from the Sovat Technocracy, one of the Alliance's most formidable foes, but today many live and work alongside us in the pursuit of a free galaxy.

Many find it difficult to trust the Naferi given their history, but since the creation of the machine god Sovat 60 years ago, the Technocracy has been isolated from the rest of the galaxy. Any Naferi you meet here can be considered true allies of freedom.

There are two recognised varieties of Naferi - Techno and Natural.

Techno Naferi are as much technology as they are biology, and have bionic enhancements that enhance their strength while limiting their natural intelligence.

Natural Naferi lack their counterpart's enhancements and limitations, and as such show less physical strength than most races, but a higher capacity for intelligence. Their natural forms also have a much shorter lifespan than their enhanced brethren.

XUREX



CLASS 1 - DISCORDANT

The Xure Republic are the single greatest threat to freedom the Alliance faces, and the Xurex make up a majority of their number. Xurex deserters are allowed in Alliance space as class 1 citizens.

Citizens of the Alliance are encouraged to employ caution when dealing with Xurex, hostile or otherwise. Revealing classified information to a Xurex is a serious offense.

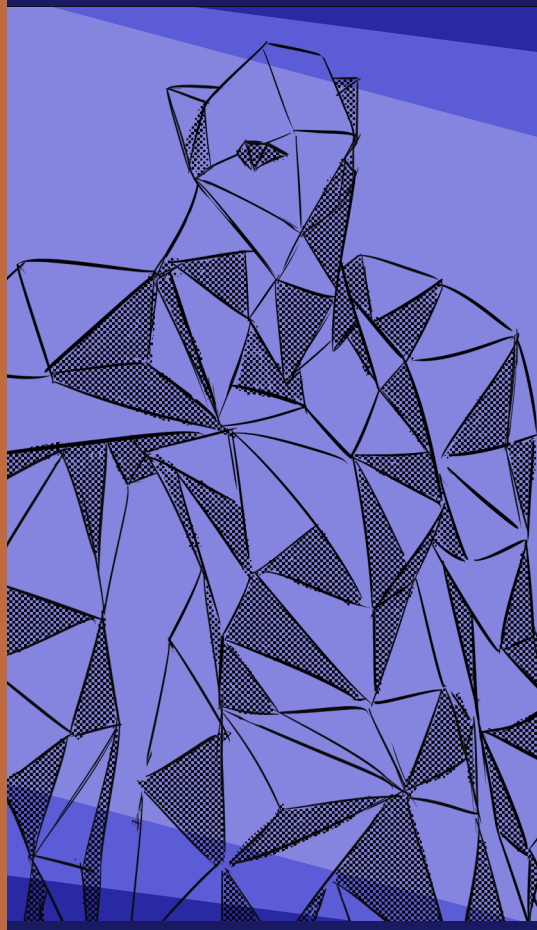
There are two varieties of Xurex - Warriors and Engineers. Both spend their early life in Xurex growth pods, growing to fit set templates. As such, there is very little variety in appearance among these races.

Warrior Xurex make up the vast majority of the Republic's combat force, averaging two metres in height. Bred for war, they are bred to be masters of all weapons.

Engineer Xurex are capable shipboard technicians, and can enhance their own capabilities by connecting to a ship's power.

CLASS 2 - FREE

STRAKRAK



The Strakrak are an unusual yet reliable clan prevalent throughout the free galaxy. Discovered only a decade ago, these crystalline beings' natural ability to reproduce by splitting into two smaller "Rak" has resulted in their influence spreading far and wide.

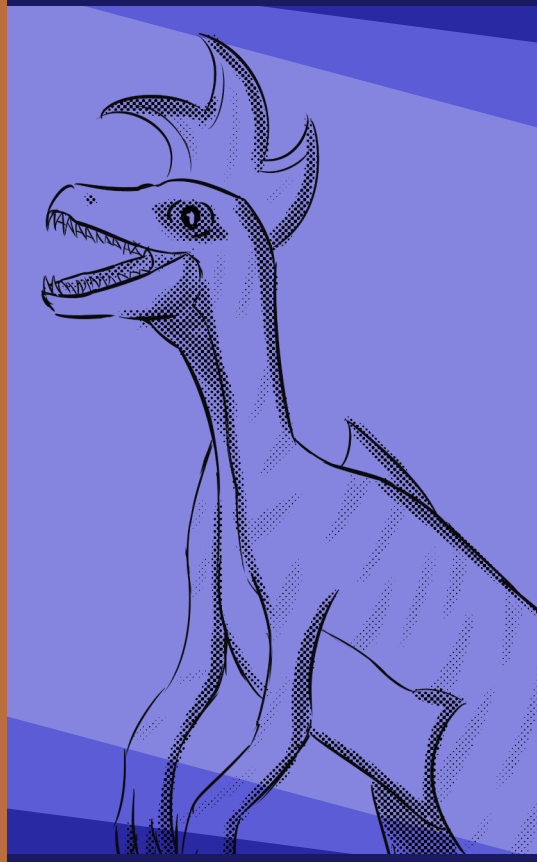
Life on their homeworld was simple, and many believe that has contributed to the clan's laid back nature. Those who remember their homeworld tend to be polite and accomodating, often to a fault, though those born elsewhere don't always maintain these traits.

When a Strakrak splits in two, the pair remain psychically linked until they mature, at which point they become two distinct beings. Keep in mind that Rak are notoriously fragile, and even if they are technically one half of a greater being, their death will still be considered murder.

Care must be taken so that the Strakrak do not reproduce infinitely, and in many parts of free space, Strakrak are required to apply for permission to split into Rak.

CLASS 3 - RENOWNED

ZAA'RU



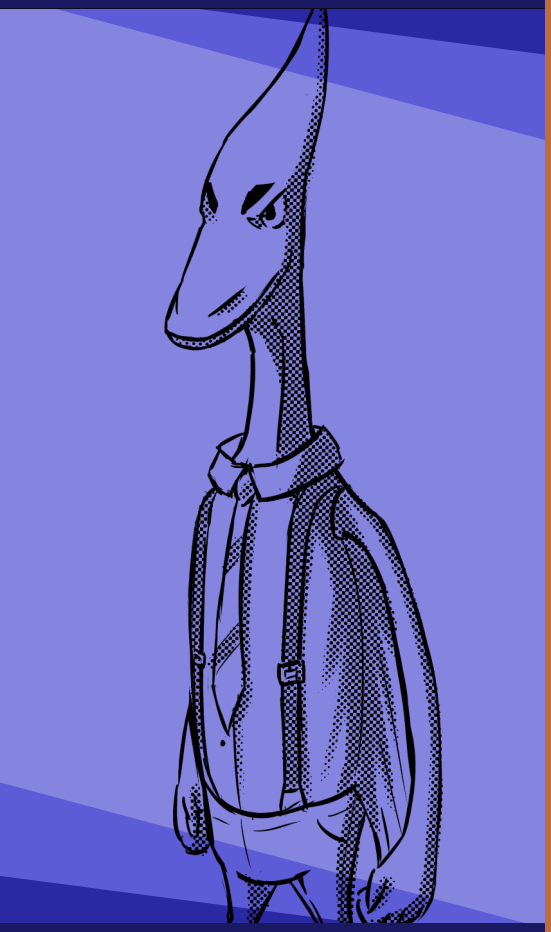
The Zaa'ru are a diverse, bipedal race inhabiting the landmasses of Planet Zaa. It's believed that there many Zaa'ru were once quadrupeds, though their race changed to match the times as technology became more prevalent, requiring the use of the Zaa'ru's hands.

Historically, Zaa'ru culture is cutthroat, relying more on force than guile to maintain order. Even today, many respected members of this clan hold positions of power within the Alliance Navy, considering them more prestigious than other political positions.

When the Europeisk Imperium made its way to the galaxy, it was discovered that the Zaa'ru shared ancestors with fierce beasts from the human homeworld, known as "dinosaurs". This name caught on among the Zaa'ru, and to this day, they see the name in a positive light, respecting the strength they wield.

The Zaa'ru, lacking thumbs, often struggle to hold standard issue equipment, and prefer to rely on their talons and claws over traditional weaponry, brandishing them with a ferocity surpassing even the most seasoned of warriors.

ZAA'EL



CLASS 3 - RENOWNED

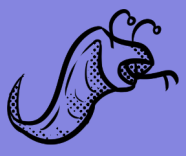
The Zaa'el are an aquatic clan from planet Zaa, where they dominated the planet's oceans with sprawling underwater cities, far from Zaa'ru territory.

While they move awkwardly on land, as blood is pumped through a Zaa'el's body, they build up air in their wings which can be expelled to propel the Zaa'el rapidly forward. As they don't require air to breathe, the Zaa'el are thus capable of space travel without a ship, however they cannot safely enter or leave a planet's atmosphere without aid.

As the Zaa'el were largely uncontested in their homeworld's ocean, they developed a cultural interest in philosophy and art, as well as developing technology that they eventually shared with the Zaa'ru.

Despite the fact that the Zaa'el appear similar to certain dinosaurs recorded in human history, they do not share a common ancestor with those beings. They have no issue with calling the Zaa'ru dinosaurs, but often see it as an insult to their species when they're compared with the ancient beings. Despite this, many humans called them "Space Pterodactyls", a term that is occasionally still used disparagingly.

LAGAR



CLASS 1 - DISCORDANT

A clan of parasitic worms with powerful psychic abilities, the Lagar are known to evade the sun by hiding in other intelligent beings, granting them improved bodily function. Evidence suggests that the Lagar can influence their host's actions, but even after seperation from the parasite, the hosts claim that they were a willing participant in the bond.

The Alliance allows the Lagar's presence so long as they are declared, and as Class 1 citizens, neither the Lagar nor their host may enlist in the military or hold positions of political power.

Once a Lagar leaves their host, the host seems to regain normal function, and remembers every action they took during their time as host. As such, past hosts are not subject to these restrictions.

If you meet a hostless Lagar, we recommend leaving them be, as their influence may change the course of your life for the worse.

If you believe that someone close to you is being negatively influenced by a Lagar parasite, please contact your local law enforcement.

CLASS 2 - FREE

Though robots and artificial intelligence are common throughout the galaxy, most are little more than vague interpretations of intelligent life. The Certoma are different - mechanical men that for all intents and purposes, function identically to sapient life.

Only a few decades ago, the Certoma were awoken from a millennia long sleep by Alliance archaeologists on planet Tyral. After a meeting with Alliance representatives, the Certoman leaders decided to maintain independence from the Alliance, most of them living out their eternal lives on Tyral, far from the conflict that engulfs the galaxy.

Certoman culture places a high emphasis on art - after all, these mechanical men need no food, water or shelter, and on a planet as peaceful as Tyral, they have nothing but time. Even those that leave their homes tend to place importance on artistic expression, wearing bodies featuring iconography important to them.

Though Certomans are not technically members of the Alliance, they are often treated as such due to cordial relationships with Tyral's political leaders.

CLASS 1 - DISCORDANT

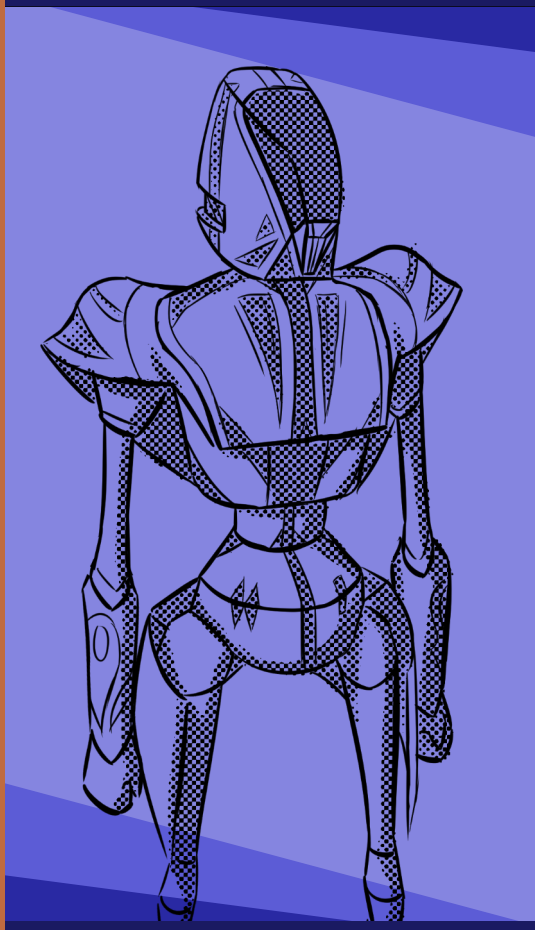
Introduced to the galaxy by the now defunct Europeisk Imperium, humans were one of the founding clans behind the Alliance of Free Planets, and to this day, many human families live full lives as class 3 citizens on the Alliance core worlds.

Unfortunately when the human-led Principality of Gronlund declared their desire to control the galaxy, the Alliance had no choice but to demote humanity to a Class 1 baseline. Thankfully, humans already living in the Alliance weren't affected by this change.

The strength of the human clan comes largely from their versatility - though they lack any abilities unique to them, they exhibit an impressive capacity for learning, and often have a vast array of skills at their disposal.

The Alliance deeply regrets that humanity has been reduced to Class 1, and hopes that the Principality of Gronlund will soon see the error of their ways.

CERTOMA



HUMANS



KLEKEN



CLASS 1 - DISCORDANT

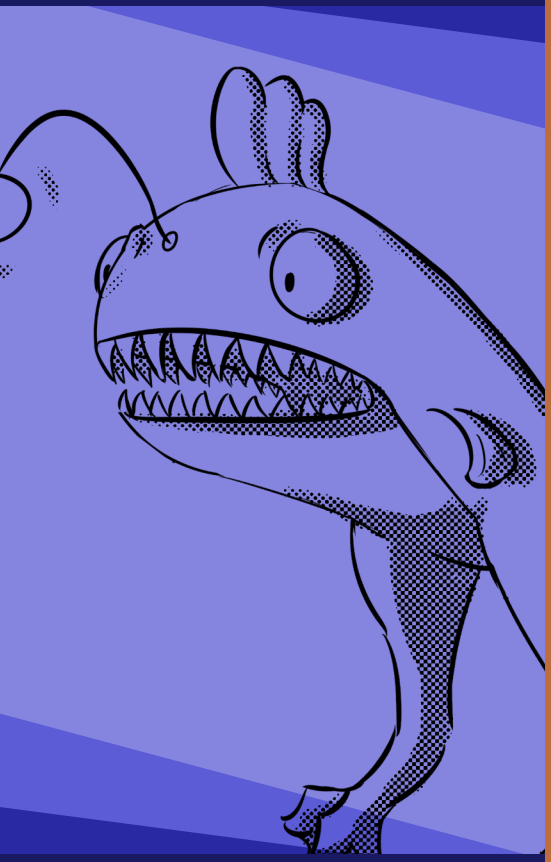
The Kleken are a clan known for their worship of the natural world, taking up tools to help them channel nature in their everyday lives. Until recently, they were a tribal people whose lives were engulfed by a daily struggle against a desperately hostile environment.

When a trader from the stars found planet Klek, the Kleken quickly proved that their lacking technology was not a result of lacking skills, and traded local mechanical and artistic masterpieces for advanced schematics and tools. Within the year, they had created their very own spaceship in the image of the Kleken Falcon.

Since then, the Kleken have developed their technology further, selling advanced technological wares to the highest bidder. Though they've been offered a position within the Alliance several times now, the Kleken elders refuse each and every time, choosing to remain neutral in the many wars throughout the galaxy.

As the Kleken are known to sell to enemies of the Alliance, they were granted Class 1 status by unanimous decision. Despite this, many exceptions have been made in the past to allow talented Kleken engineers to work with the Alliance Navy.

LAMPFACES



CLASS 2 - FREE

The Alliance would like to assert that the name "Lampface" was coined by the clan's own representative, despite rumours to the contrary.

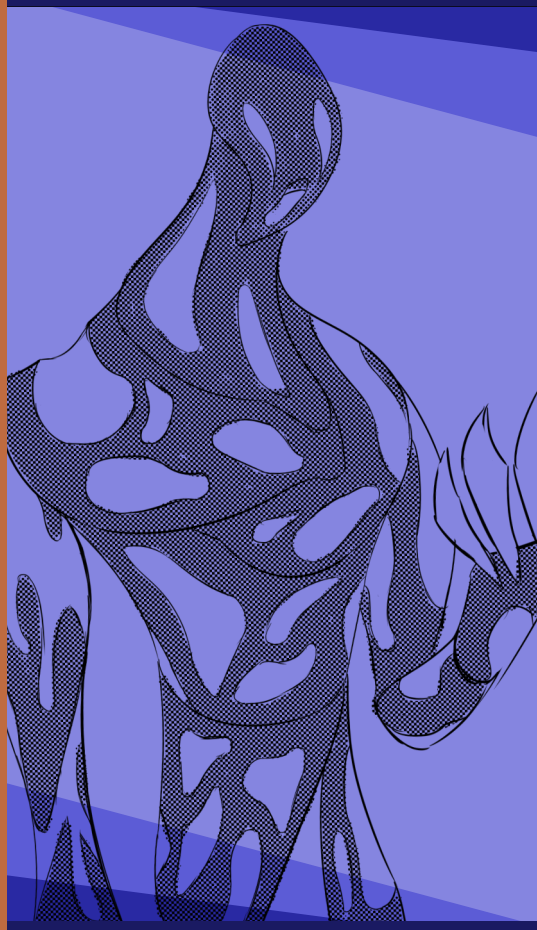
The Lampfaces are a respected clan of psychics hailing from the deep waters of a planet now under the control of the Xure Republic. According to their own story, the Lampface population collectively controlled the minds of the invading Xure fleet, using their ships to escape their home's invasion.

Though they lack arms, the Lampface people are able to lift objects with their mind, wielding them just as effectively as any other race might. The orb hanging from their foreheads glows when they activate their psychic abilities, its brightness determined by their psychic prowess. In some cases, the light has been used to signal ships from orbit.

It is worth noting that the Lampfaces lack the ability to speak verbally, instead broadcasting their thoughts telepathically. Though this broadcast may be disorienting at first, it is in no way dangerous to its recipients.

CLASS 0 - INELIGIBLE

PAAL ILD



Hailing from planet Thatch in the Exidere star system, the Paal Ild are among the few races that can withstand the heat of the stars. Having witnessed the destruction of their planet first hand as it drifted too close to Exidere, the strange radiation of the star accelerated their evolution, turning their stone skin molten to allow them to survive the intense heat.

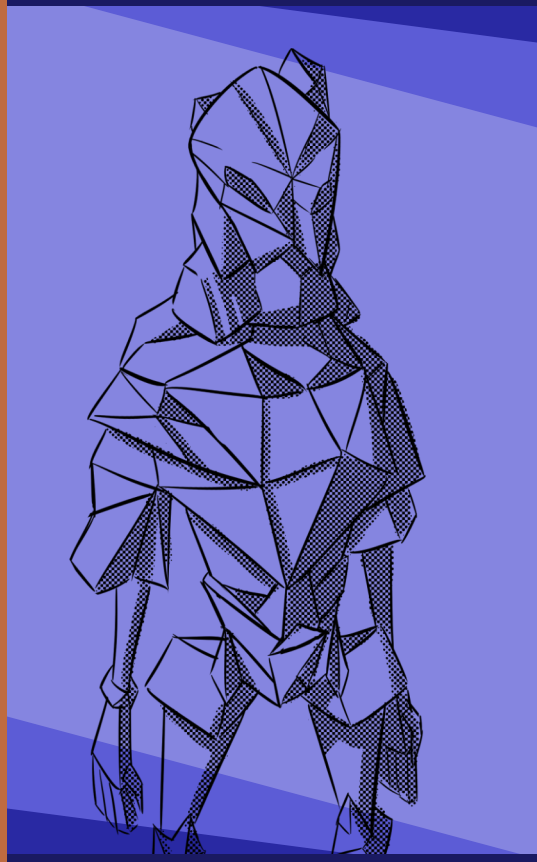
Their molten skin makes it almost impossible for them to use conventional equipment unless it's made from Ildium - an abundant element on planet Thatch that has yet to be discovered anywhere else.

Planet Thatch's destruction was a byproduct of the Paal people's constant march towards progress, heedless of the danger said progress presented to their way of life. They're capable of building advanced technology, but are severely limited by their reliance on Ildium.

The Paal Ild are refused entry to Alliance space due to the innate danger they pose to life and infrastructure, but they can still apply for temporary entry under the close watch of Alliance authorities.

CLASS 2 - FREE

PAAL ZOL



Having fled from planet Thatch well before its destruction, the Paal Zol were once the upper class of their civilisation. Their unmodified bodies retain their original resilient stone skin which they can shape to their needs.

The Paal Zol are seen as traitors by the Paal Ild, and in the years following Thatch's destruction, many of the Zol were hunted down and killed. Today, only a few still live, though the Alliance is taking action to ensure their clan's survival.

Paal Zol technology is unique in that they tend to prefer stone and similar materials over metal, using their unique abilities to shape it to their needs, often repairing it using their own stone skin.

The Paal Zol lack the Ild's resistance to solar radiation and heat, but as they pose no direct threat to other life, they are welcome in the Alliance of Free Planets.

NESKEL



CLASS 3 - RENOWNED

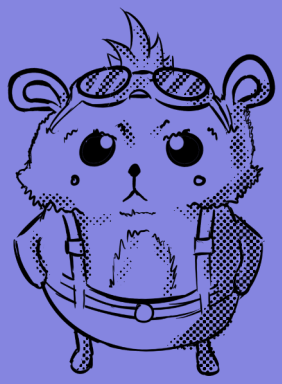
Believed to originally be an attempted Xuran biological weapon, the Neskel are a colony of much smaller beings known as Neskelli. These smaller beings lack intelligence compared to most of the galaxy's clans, but together they form a hive mind that functions just as well as any other sapient being.

The Neskel can send these Neskelli out to perform simple tasks, though doing so causes significant strain on the hivemind and results in the death of the Neskelli sent. Regardless, a Neskel regains Neskelli at such a rapid rate that many use this ability regularly heedless of the consequences.

Visually, the Neskel subconsciously adapt their appearances to match other beings that had a strong influence on their hivemind. That said, their facade is not complex - if you're aware of their existence, a Neskel's true identity is obvious, even from a distance.

When the Neskel were first discovered by Alliance scientists, they had recently escaped containment by the Xure Republic, and so appeared as Xurex at first glance. Fortunately, this misunderstanding was cleared quickly, and now many Neskel live as citizens of the Alliance.

AITA



CLASS 3 - RENOWNED

A race of fuzzballs beloved throughout Alliance space, the Aita are the creative minds behind some of the most advanced technology we have to offer. Their homeworld, Attica, is one of the core worlds of the Alliance of Free Planets, and houses some of our largest shipyards.

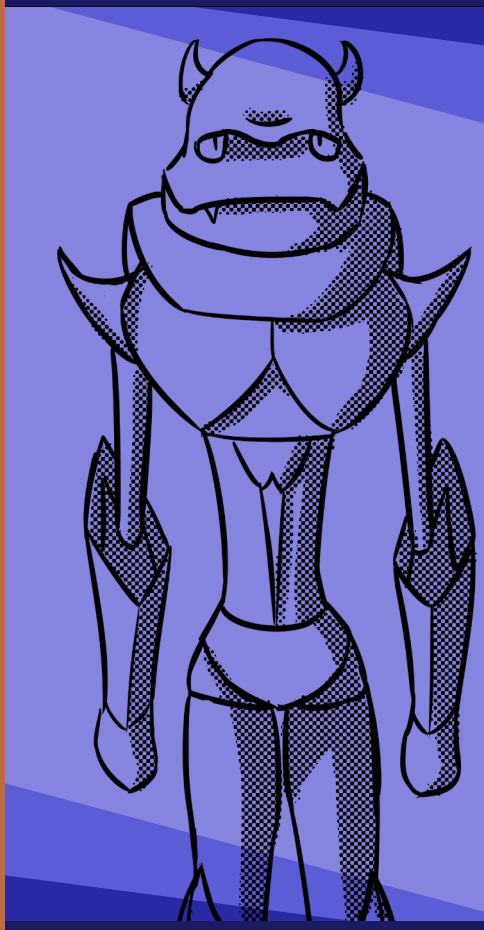
The Aita are known for their inherent ability to construct complex blueprints within their mind and then construct them within days, if not hours. It seems that the only limit this ability has is the Aita's own imagination, though some are more successful than others at bringing their ideas to life.

Aita that fail to utilise their natural abilities are still no less capable in other fields than other clans. Many Aita have enlisted in the Alliance Navy, while others work as shipboard mechanics for freighters, spacestations and other starships.

The Aita are visually diverse, with a wide variety of lengths and colours of fur, though all Aita are shorter than the galactic average, less than a metre tall.

CLASS 2 - FREE

GHONN



By all conventional logic, planet Ghonn, the closest to its system's star, should not be able to support life - the temperatures are too high during the day, and too low during the night. Despite this, the Ghonn people managed to barely survive, desperately clinging to the shadows.

Two methods of survival arose throughout the clan's history, evolving into the two subtypes we see today - the travelers and tunnelers.

Traveler Ghonn grew long, spindly legs which they used to walk around the planet faster than the sun's light could reach them. They evolved past any need for sleep, and seem to actually recover their energy through travel rather than using it up.

Tunneler Ghonn are the shorter of the two, but their mole-like claws allow them to tunnel through soil and stone almost as easily as they walk. For centuries, their eyes have adjusted to the darkness of the underground, and so they tend to struggle with bright light, particularly that of the sun.

All Ghonn are welcome in the Alliance, having escaped their home system's occupation by Xuran forces.

CLASS 0 - UNIDENTIFIED

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